

Yes, if you live in New South Wales, Victoria, South Australia or South East Queensland.

No, if you live in Tasmania, the Northern Territory, or most parts of Western Australia (in which case you may still be able to save on your gas bill instead).

But it's not as straightforward as you'd think.

I typed 'cheap power' into Google and started dutifully scrolling through the 136 000 000 results it served up. The top pages were power comparison sites, and they reminded me of walking through a market in Bali:

'Hey mister! You want free power?''*

'Cheap price, lady!''*

'Two dollar gas for you!''*

** Just sign up for a horribly confusing bait-and-switch plan that will tempt you with low prices but see you being charged an average \$278 more for power the year after your deal expires.*

So, when it comes to electricity research, direct your teen to the Government website Energy Made Easy (energymadeeasy.gov.au).

Apparently less than 10 per cent of the population have heard of this website, according to the Australian Energy Market Commission. So think of Energy Made Easy like an underground nightclub no one knows about, where cool indie bands play incognito and you can get loaded really cheap.

After punching in the basic details (gleaned from the bill), your teen will be presented with a list of offers—up to three at the same time. Once they've found a good offer, they can read and print an energy price fact sheet from the Energy Made Easy website summarising the key points.

Step 4: Celebrate!

When I did this switch a while ago myself, I saved \$500 a year.